

Abby Thompson

Cycle	Probation Period Review Aug-Dec 2025
Release date	October 31, 2025

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Manager review

By Laith Wallace on October 31, 2025

Section 1

1. Mid-Probation Manager's Review

 **When to complete:** Fill out this section **at the midpoint of probation** period. Once completed, make sure to save the form.

Mid-Probation: Review of Employee's Goals

Please make sure the employee's probation goals are set in Personio. To do this:
Go to Performance → Goals → Create new goal, then follow the steps as prompted in the system.

 Once you've reviewed or added the goals, confirm below:
Optional: Use the comment box to note any updates, priorities, or areas to revisit in the second half of probation.

☒ I confirm I have set the goals

Comment

"

Abby has successfully achieved her probation goals. She made **significant contributions** to the **Quick Wins project**, demonstrating a strong ability to jump into a new team and deliver value quickly. Her feature work on the **Request Detail page improvements** was delivered and well received and showed great attention to user experience. Additionally, she was a key contributor to the **Design system**, which was a goal beyond her immediate feature work

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Mid-Probation: Manager's Review

Please reflect on how the employee is progressing in their role so far. What has gone well so far? You might also consider any early challenges they've encountered, how they're settling into the team and ways of working, how they're communicating and collaborating, and how well they're demonstrating Vertice's values.

Answer

Abby has been an excellent addition to the Product Design team. Her willingness to get stuck in and take ownership of projects like the Quick Wins initiative and the Request Detail page improvements is highly commendable. She quickly adapted to our ways of working and has become a reliable collaborator with product management and engineering.

Strengths: She should be most proud of her ability to quickly integrate into the team and her proactive approach to design challenges. Her work on the Design System shows a commitment to long-term team infrastructure. **She has also demonstrated an outstanding ability to build proactive working relationships with our Engineering team, moving beyond hand-offs to co-solutioning, which significantly improves delivery efficiency. Furthermore, her ability to ask tough, foundational questions has immediately elevated the strategic discussions around new initiatives like Contracts.**

Development Areas/Priorities: Over the next few months, I'd like her to prioritise developing a deeper understanding of our strategic product roadmap and taking on more complex, long-running feature ownership to further grow her influence within the product vertical. **We should specifically focus on formalizing her proactive questioning habits into a repeatable framework for all new feature kick-offs, ensuring clear metrics are defined before design begins.**

Abby has been able to overcome many challenges while still remaining positive, optimistic and proactive, I'd love to see that continue as we move into the new year.

Section 2

2. End of Probation Review

 **When to complete:** Fill out this section **before the end of probation** period. Once completed, make sure to save the form.

End of Probation: Review of Employee's Goals

Review the employee's goals set at the start of their employment:

Go to Performance -> Goals (select the relevant employee, click the arrow icon next to the relevant goal) to review the employee's probation goals and assess their progress.

Then confirm their status below:

Optional: Use the comment section to reflect on their overall goal performance (highlight achievements, explain any blockers, or note any goals that may need adjusting or extending beyond probation).

- ☐ Goals MET – The employee has achieved the goals set at the start of probation
- ☐ Goals PARTIALLY met – The employee has made strong progress, with a few goals still in progress
- ☐ Goals NOT met – Significant goals remain incomplete or require more time

End of Probation: Manager's Review

Please reflect in more depth on the employee's progress and impact throughout their probation period (beyond what was covered at the midpoint).

You might consider their overall performance, how their impact has developed over time, and where they've contributed the most value. You can also reflect on how they've worked with you and the wider team, how they've adapted to our ways of working, and what you've observed about their strengths and development areas.

What should they be most proud of? Where have they made the biggest difference? Are there areas where further support or focus is needed? What would you like them to prioritise over the next few months?

This section is intended to capture a well-rounded view of their contribution and trajectory at this key milestone.

Answer

Abby has had a highly successful probation period. She **consistently meets and often exceeds expectations**, particularly in her willingness to take on critical team projects like the Design System and Quick Wins. She delivers strong, user-centric results and contributes positively to the team dynamic.

Overall Performance During Probation

How would you rate the employee's overall performance during their probation period?

Please select a rating and include a mandatory comment explaining your choice.

- ☐ 1 – Gaps: The employee is not consistently meeting role expectations. There are skill or performance gaps, and they often require guidance.
- ☐ 2 – Still Developing: The employee is making progress and meeting some expectations, but still has areas to develop. With more experience, they
- ☐ 3 – Successful: The employee consistently meets expectations and delivers strong results. They contribute positively to team goals and occasior
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Self review

By Abby Thompson on October 27, 2025

Section 1

1. Mid-Probation Self Review

 **When to complete:** Fill out this section **at the midpoint of your probation** period. Once completed, make sure to save the form.

Mid-Probation: Review of Goals

Go to the Goals section (Performance → Goals) to review the goals your manager set for your probation. If anything isn't clear, feel free to check in with your manager.

 Once you've reviewed them, confirm completion below.

Optional: You can also add any comments.

☒ I confirm that I have reviewed my Goals

Comment

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"

Mid-Probation: Self Review

Please reflect on your experience so far and share how you feel you're progressing in your role. You might touch on areas such as what's gone well, any challenges you've faced, how you're settling into the team and culture, your communication and collaboration, alignment with company values, or any support that would help you succeed. Feel free to focus on what feels most relevant to you.

Answer

Misalignment with ways of working from a managerial aspect. Missing leadership from product or standard practices to ensure the product vision was heading in the right direction.

Mid-Probation: Role Expectations

How well is the role matching your expectations so far?

Optional: Feel free to add a few comments (for example, what's exceeded your expectations, what you've particularly enjoyed, or where you'd like to see more growth or clarity).

Above expectations – The role has offered more opportunities, learning, or impact than expected

Meets expectations – The role aligns well with what you were expecting and feels like a good fit

Below expectations – Some aspects of the role haven't fully matched expectations yet

Comment

"

Misalignment with ways of working from a managerial aspect. Missing leadership from product or standard practices to ensure the product vision was heading in the right direction.

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Section 2

2. End of Probation Review

 **When to complete:** Fill out this section **before the end of your probation** period. Once completed, make sure to save the form.

End of Probation - Review of Goals

Go to the Goals section in Personio (Performance > Goals) to review and update your progress. Then confirm your status below.

Optional: Use the comment section to reflect on your progress (for example, highlight achievements, explain any blockers, or suggest any goals that may need adjusting going forward).

- ☒ I have met my goals – You've achieved the goals set at the start of your probation
- ☐ I have partially met my goals – You've made good progress, with a few still in progress
- ☐ I have not met my goals – Some goals remain unmet or need more time

Comment

"

Highlights were as follows

- Positive feedback on the request page redesign. Fulfilling to be able to piece together all the constraints and user goals for the page.
- Working on quick wins to visually impact the product and align with engineering and product to move forward together to improve the product.
- Other features such as Verity AI prompts in situ, Conversations on Contracts and the Command palette.
- Working with the design team to understand our rituals and create processes to build the product faster and more effectively
- Working with engineering to understand how we can solve our product problems together as a team

"

End of Probation: Self Review

As you reach the end of your probation period, take this opportunity to reflect in more depth on your time at Vertice so far (beyond what was covered at the midpoint).

You might consider your overall performance, how your impact has developed, and where you've contributed the most value. You can also reflect on how you've worked with your manager and team, adjusted to the way we work, and what you've learned about your strengths and development areas.

What are you most proud of? Where have you made the biggest difference? Where have you added value or contributed to team goals? What do you want to focus on in the months ahead?

Feel free to structure your response in the way that makes most sense to you. This section is designed to help capture your progress and perspective at this key milestone.

Answer

Highlights were as follows

- Positive feedback on the request page redesign. Fulfilling to be able to piece together all the constraints and user goals for the page.
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- Working with engineering to understand how we can solve our product problems together as a team

Blockers

- Moving back from Product solutionizing from the get go. When we have the conversations from the start and really question what problem we're really trying to solve we can create solutions (with engineering and design in the room) that will work and will be feasible.

Proud

- I've been most proud of seeing the team really get together to try improve our ways of working after having a management shift. Laith and Kris really stepped up.
- Proud of seeing the team come together in person in Brno to do some team building as well as getting the front end engineers and the design team together to do a retro on our ways of working as well.

We're still a relatively small company so we can pivot really quickly when we need to and we need to make sure that everyone feels like they have the power to make change like that. To speak up and say hey this isn't the best way to do things because of "this" and "this" let's fix it.

- I've also been very proud about the working relationship I've been developing with the engineers. Empowering them to look at the Figma and call out anything that might not work as soon as possible as well as having conversations with them over zoom or a huddle to quickly peer program or peer design. This saves a lot of time and back and forth as they can understand the user needs and I can understand the feasibilities/constraints.

Difference

- The difference I've been trying to make is to really understand the problems we're trying to solve. What metrics are we trying to push (what are we trying to change? and why). I don't believe in building things just because and putting our heads in the sand (which is what it felt like we were doing in the first part of my probation period).
 - What I've seen is that when we have our heads in the sand and have no direction as to why we're doing a feature we have no guiding light. We pivot half way through designs or code is done and waste precious time and money when we could have answered questions so much earlier in the process.
 - I'm already seeing that when I'm asking questions about conversations on contracts we can really solidify our user flow and not be designing up in the ether with no grounding principles. Saving us time as we start laying out the UI.
- I've been a driving force in trying to get our team to think about consistency in our designs. Making sure that we're creating rituals and communication that will increase visibility onto overlapping features. We can't be designing 20 different headers anymore.
- I've picked up the quick wins work and worked with Laith and Maryna to quickly come up with designs that overlap in consistency and low effort work for developers. With my developer background I find it very easy to find these easy wins.

End of Probation: Role Expectations**How well is the role matching your expectations at this stage?**

Optional: Feel free to add a few comments (for example, what's continued to go well, what's changed since the midpoint, or where you'd like to see further development or clarity).

- ☐ Above expectations – The role has offered more opportunities, learning, or impact than expected
- ☒ Meets expectations – The role continues to align well with what you were expecting and feels like a good fit
- ☐ Below expectations – Some aspects of the role still haven't fully matched expectations

Comment

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Laith has been a pivotal factor in the improvement of my experience at Vertice. Even just through the last 2 weeks of his management.

He's made me feel much more valued in the company and focused on my personal and career progression as a Product designer. He's constantly trying to find opportunities for me to improve my skillset and understand how I tick as a human being. I really appreciate his management style so far.

He's humble, a strong designer, leader and I can tell that he wants to team succeed above all else.

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Overall Performance During Probation**How would you rate your overall performance during your probation period?**

Please select a rating and include a short comment explaining your choice.

- ☐ 1 – Gaps: I've struggled to consistently meet expectations and still need significant support to perform in my role.
- ☐ 2 – Still Developing: I'm making progress and meeting some expectations, but there are still areas I need to improve. I feel I'm on the right track v
- ☐ 3 – Successful: I consistently meet expectations, contribute to team goals, and feel confident in the work I've done so far.
- ☐ 4 – Extraordinary: I regularly exceed expectations, take on challenges, and contribute meaningfully to the team's success.
- ☒ 5 – Redefines: I go well beyond what's expected, drive impact, and help set the bar for others through my work and mindset.

Responses overview by question

Manager review

Mid-Probation: Review of Employee's Goals

Answers (1)

By Laith Wallace

October 31, 2025

 I confirm I have set the goals

Abby has successfully achieved her probation goals. She made **significant contributions** to the **Quick Wins project**, demonstrating a strong ability to jump into a new team and deliver value quickly. Her feature work on the **Request Detail page improvements** was delivered and well received and showed great attention to user experience. Additionally, she was a key contributor to the **Design system**, which was a goal beyond her immediate feature work

Mid-Probation: Manager's Review

Answers (1)

By Laith Wallace

October 31, 2025

Answer

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End of Probation: Review of Employee's Goals

Answers (1)

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Self review

 Mid-Probation: Review of Goals

Answers (1)

By Abby Thompson

October 27, 2025

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Mid-Probation: Self Review

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By Abby Thompson

October 27, 2025

Answer

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Answers (1)

By Abby Thompson

October 27, 2025

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Overall Performance During Probation

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By Abby Thompson

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